

Mastering pandas groupby, crosstab, and melt

Introduction

- `pandas` is a powerful Python library for data analysis. Three of its most useful tools for summarizing and reshaping data are `groupby`, `crosstab`, and `melt`. Understanding how to use these functions effectively can greatly enhance your data analysis capabilities.

`groupby`: Grouping and Aggregating Data

Syntax

```
DataFrame.groupby(by=None, axis=0, level=None, as_index=True, sort=True, group_keys=Tru
```

Example: Sales Data

Let's create a synthetic dataset representing sales transactions:

```
import pandas as pd

# Sample sales data
data = {
    'Region': ['North', 'South', 'East', 'West', 'North', 'South', 'East', 'West'],
    'Product': ['A', 'A', 'B', 'B', 'A', 'B', 'A', 'B'],
    'Sales': [250, 150, 200, 300, 400, 120, 330, 500]
}

df = pd.DataFrame(data)
print(df)
```

Output: `[[]]`

Region	Product	Sales
North	A	250
South	A	150

Region	Product	Sales
East	B	200
West	B	300
North	A	400
South	B	120
East	A	330
West	B	500

Grouping by Region

```
# Total sales by region
region_sales = df.groupby('Region')['Sales'].sum()
print(region_sales)
```

Output:

Region	Sales
East	530
North	650
South	270
West	800
Name: Sales, dtype: int64	

Grouping by Region and Product

```
# Total sales by region and product
region_product_sales = df.groupby(['Region', 'Product'])['Sales'].sum()
print(region_product_sales)
```

Output: `{Obj}`

Region	Product	Sales
East	A	330
East	B	200
North	A	650
South	A	150
South	B	120
West	B	800

Common Aggregation Functions

- `.sum()` – Total sum
- `.mean()` – Average
- `.count()` – Count of non-NA/null entries
- `.min()` / `.max()` – Minimum / Maximum
- `.agg()` – Multiple aggregations `[OBJ]` `[OBJ]`

```
# Multiple aggregations
aggregated = df.groupby('Product')['Sales'].agg(['sum', 'mean', 'count'])
print(aggregated)
```

Output:

Product	Sum	Mean	Count
A	830	276.666667	3
B	1120	280.000000	4

crosstab: Cross-Tabulation of Categorical Data

Syntax

```
pd.crosstab(index, columns, values=None, rownames=None, colnames=None, aggfunc=None, ma
```

Example: Customer Preferences

- Let's create a synthetic dataset representing customer preferences:

```
# Sample customer data
data = {
    'Gender': ['Male', 'Female', 'Female', 'Male', 'Female', 'Male', 'Male', 'Female'],
    'Preference': ['Tea', 'Coffee', 'Tea', 'Coffee', 'Tea', 'Tea', 'Coffee', 'Coffee']
}

df = pd.DataFrame(data)
print(df)
```

Output: `[0]`

Gender	Preference
Male	Tea
Female	Coffee
Female	Tea
Male	Coffee
Female	Tea
Male	Tea
Male	Coffee
Female	Coffee

Basic Crosstab

```
# Frequency table of Gender vs Preference
ct = pd.crosstab(df['Gender'], df['Preference'])
print(ct)
```

Output: `[0]`

Gender	Coffee	Tea
Female	2	2

Gender	Coffee	Tea
Male	2	2

Crosstab with Aggregation

- Suppose we have scores associated with each entry:

```
# Adding scores to the dataset
df['Score'] = [85, 90, 88, 75, 95, 80, 70, 92]
print(df)
```

Output:

Gender	Preference	Score
Male	Tea	85
Female	Coffee	90
Female	Tea	88
Male	Coffee	75
Female	Tea	95
Male	Tea	80
Male	Coffee	70
Female	Coffee	92

```
# Average score by Gender and Preference
ct_avg = pd.crosstab(df['Gender'], df['Preference'], values=df['Score'], aggfunc='mean')
print(ct_avg)
```

Output:

Gender	Coffee	Tea
Female	91.0	91.5
Male	72.5	82.5

Adding Margins and Normalization

```
# Crosstab with totals and normalized values
ct_norm = pd.crosstab(df['Gender'], df['Preference'], margins=True, normalize='index')
print(ct_norm)
```

Output:

Gender	Coffee	Tea	All
Female	0.5	0.5	1.0
Male	0.5	0.5	1.0
All	0.5	0.5	1.0

melt: Reshaping Data from Wide to Long Format

Syntax

```
pd.melt(frame, id_vars=None, value_vars=None, var_name=None, value_name='value', col_le
```

Example: Student Scores

- Let's create a synthetic dataset representing student scores:

```
# Sample student data
data = {
    'Name': ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Charlie'],
    'Math': [85, 90, 78],
    'Science': [88, 92, 84],
    'History': [82, 85, 80]
}

df = pd.DataFrame(data)
print(df)
```

Output:

Name	Math	Science	History
Alice	85	88	82
Bob	90	92	85
Charlie	78	84	80

Melting the DataFrame

```
# Reshaping from wide to long format
melted_df = pd.melt(df, id_vars=['Name'], var_name='Subject', value_name='Score')
print(melted_df)
```

Output: `[0]`

Name	Subject	Score
Alice	Math	85
Bob	Math	90
Charlie	Math	78
Alice	Science	88
Bob	Science	92
Charlie	Science	84
Alice	History	82
Bob	History	85
Charlie	History	80

Customizing Column Names

```
# Customizing the variable and value column names
melted_df = pd.melt(df, id_vars=['Name'], var_name='Subject', value_name='Score')
print(melted_df)
```

Output:

Name	Subject	Score
Alice	Math	85
Bob	Math	90
Charlie	Math	78
Alice	Science	88
Bob	Science	92
Charlie	Science	84